ClockFace User Guide



Version 1.1.1 | OBS Studio 33 | Windows macOS and Linux | November 2 2026

ClockFace adds an analog clock source with selectable artwork, background images, and daily countdown messages. The goal was to replace the aging ClockSource.LUA script. This guide covers installation on each OBS platform and the version 1.1.1 controls.

Choose the correct installer

Download the ClockFace installer matching your operating system and OBS architecture. Each installer places the plugin and its resources in the appropriate location. A Windows DLL cannot run on macOS or Linux.

OBS platform	Select this installer	Plugin format
Windows x64	Windows x64 installer	.dll
Windows portable x64	Windows installer with portable destination	.dll
macOS Apple silicon	Apple silicon macOS installer	.plugin bundle
macOS Intel	Intel macOS installer	.plugin bundle
Linux native	Package for your distribution and architecture	.so library
Linux Flatpak	Not included in this release	Separate extension required

The installer must support your OBS version. Use the platform instructions on the following pages, then configure the clock using the common controls described later in this guide.

Before installing

Close OBS completely. Use only the matching platform package and retain its supplied folder structure and support files. Keep a copy of the previous plugin until the replacement has been checked.

Earlier test versions: ClockFace uses a new source type. Remove old clock plugin copies before installing, then add **ClockFace** as a new source and recreate its settings. Old test sources do not convert automatically. Keep a scene backup. Relink background images when moving between systems.

The following pages provide platform installation instructions, appearance controls, time zones, scheduled messages, external text sources, and troubleshooting.

Install on Windows

Standard installation

1. Close OBS completely.
2. Run the **ClockFace Windows x64 installer**.
3. Select the standard OBS installation and complete setup. Approve a Windows permission prompt if required.
4. Restart OBS, then follow Start the clock below.

The standard OBS 33 plugin location is:

```
C:\ProgramData\obs-studio\plugins\ClockFace\ClockFace.dll
```

Windows portable installation

1. Close the portable OBS instance.
2. Run the Windows installer and choose its **portable installation** option or destination.
3. Select the portable OBS root folder, which contains bin. Do not select bin/64bit itself.
4. Complete setup, launch that OBS instance in portable mode, and add the clock.

For a portable OBS root of D:\OBS, the plugin belongs here:

```
D:\OBS\plugins\ClockFace\ClockFace.dll
```

Portable launches ignore plugins in ProgramData. Each separate portable installation needs its own plugin installation.

Manual installation fallback

If using a ZIP package, preserve its supplied layout. For the current Windows DLL-only package, create the appropriate ClockFace folder above, copy in the DLL, and name it **ClockFace.dll**. Its artwork is bundled inside the DLL. The folder and DLL names must match.

Setup removes OBS-Clock.dll from a sibling OBS-Clock test folder. Manually remove other earlier test copies, including simple-clock.dll and OBSClock.dll, from other OBS plugin locations. Leave unrelated plugins in place. Do not put third-party plugins in core or use the older bin/64bit nesting under ProgramData.

Start the clock

1. Start OBS. In a scene, select **Sources > + > ClockFace** and create a new source.
2. Start with **Broadcast** for Face, **Broadcast** for Hands, and **Smooth sweep** for second-hand movement.
3. Resize and position the clock using the source transform handles in OBS.

Install on macOS and Linux

macOS Apple silicon and Intel

1. Quit OBS completely and remove the earlier OBS-Clock.plugin test bundle.
2. Open the **ClockFace macOS installer** matching your OBS architecture: Apple silicon ARM64 or Intel x86_64.
3. Complete the installer and follow any macOS permission prompts.
4. Restart OBS. Select **Sources > + > ClockFace** and create a source.

Manual installation fallback: If the release supplies a bundle instead, in Finder choose Go > Go to Folder and enter:

```
~/Library/Application Support/obs-studio/plugins/
```

Create the plugins folder if needed and copy the complete **ClockFace.plugin** bundle into it. The tilde means your home folder. Keep the bundle intact; do not copy or rename the Windows DLL.

Linux native installation

1. Close OBS completely.
2. Install the **ClockFace DEB** for native Ubuntu 26.04 x64 and OBS 33.0.1 or later using your package installer. The package replaces the earlier obs-clock test package.
3. Complete any dependency installation requested by the package manager.
4. Restart OBS and add **ClockFace** through Sources.

Manual installation fallback: For OBS 33, copy the Linux library into its own folder under the user data directory:

```
~/.local/share/obs-studio/plugins/ClockFace/ClockFace.so
```

If XDG_DATA_HOME is set, use that directory instead of ~/.local/share. The Ubuntu installer uses /usr/lib/x86_64-linux-gnu/obs-modules/plugins/. Keep the package layout intact. The Windows DLL cannot run on Linux.

Linux Flatpak installation

The current release does not include a Flatpak extension. Its native Ubuntu DEB cannot install into Flatpak OBS. Use native Ubuntu OBS for this test release; Flatpak requires a separately built extension matching its runtime and architecture.

Choose the clock appearance

Face and **Hands** are separate choices. Select both when trying a coordinated style, or mix them to create another look. The following pairings are useful starting points.

Face	Suggested hands	Character
Broadcast	Broadcast	Clean markings and tapered hands
Railway	Railway	Heavy rectangular marks and a round second-hand tip
Classic ivory	Classic ornate black or brass	Roman numerals and an ivory dial
Studio Dark	Studio white and orange	Charcoal dial with bright hands
Church Tower	Gothic brass	Decorative rim and traditional numerals
Neon	Neon	Cyan and purple accents with adjustable glow
Minimal transparent	Minimal	Sparse markings for an overlay

The original face choices and hand sets are also available. On some older raster styles, separately controlled markings may look slightly different from the original flattened artwork.

Control the markings and motion

Show tick marks and **Show numbers** are independent. Check either, both, or neither. **Show second hand** separately controls whether the second hand is visible.

Choose **One-second tick**, **Quarter-second tick**, or **Smooth sweep** for second-hand movement. These choices do not change the displayed time.

Opacity controls the entire clock source: 100% is fully visible and 0% is invisible. The checkboxes follow the Opacity slider in the properties window.

Use the Neon controls

Choose Neon as the face or hand style to reveal **Neon glow**. Select **Neon transparent face** to remove the dark dial background. A separate background image can still be used behind the clock.

Tip: Leave Override artwork colors off when you want the designed colors of a selected face and hand set.

Add an image and change colors

Use a background image

1. At the bottom of the properties window, check **Use background image**.
2. Select an image in the file picker that appears. PNG, JPEG, and BMP files are supported. Square artwork is recommended; it is scaled to the clock's 500 by 500 pixel dial area.
3. If the image already contains a clock dial, turn **Show tick marks** and **Show numbers** off. Otherwise, keep the markings you want ClockFace to supply.
4. Choose hands that remain readable over the image. A PNG can include transparent areas.

The background replaces the built-in plate while selected markings and hands remain separate layers. Unchecking Use background image restores the built-in plate and retains your chosen image path for later use.

Override artwork colors

Check **Override artwork colors** to reveal the color controls. Uncheck it to return to the artwork and default text colors; saved color choices are retained.

Color control	What it changes
Face and background tint	Tints the plate or image while preserving its details
Numbers color	Changes the clock numerals
Tick marks color	Changes the hour and minute marks
Hour hand color	Changes the hour-hand silhouette
Minute hand color	Changes the minute-hand silhouette
Second hand color	Changes the second-hand silhouette
Digital time and date color	Changes the labels drawn by the clock
Countdown color	Changes the message drawn under the clock

Use Opacity for transparency rather than looking for an alpha control in a color picker. In external text-source mode, format the message in that text source; the clock's Countdown color is hidden.

Set digital time and time zones

Add time and date labels

Check **Show digital time below dial** or **Show date below dial** to add either label. Digital time supports 12-hour or 24-hour display and optional seconds. The date can use a descriptive format or YYYY-MM-DD.

Text is white by default. To change it, check Override artwork colors and use **Digital time and date color**. This can improve contrast over a light scene.

Adding labels increases the source height. You may need to adjust the source transform after enabling them. Each inline text row adds 44 pixels below the 500 by 500 pixel dial. Labels are separate from the face artwork.

Select a time zone

The default is **System local time**. Choose **UTC** or another available time zone when offered by your platform build. Time-zone names can differ by operating system. The hands, digital labels, date, and scheduled message all use that source's selected zone.

The operating system applies its daylight-saving rules. On Windows, a label such as Mountain Standard Time identifies the zone even while it is observing daylight time. UTC has no daylight-saving adjustment.

ClockFace uses the computer's system clock as its time reference. It does not add a separate time-synchronization service.

Create independent clocks

Create a new ClockFace source for each independently configured clock. For example, use one source for local time and another for UTC.

Adding an existing source to another scene creates another reference to that same clock and its settings. Choose a new source when you want a different face, message schedule, or time zone.

Daylight-saving note: The message schedule follows the displayed wall-clock time. If a time repeats during the autumn clock change, its countdown interval can repeat as well.

Show a scheduled message

There are two levels of message controls. **Show message** enables the feature. The optional **Send to OBS text source instead of clock** checkbox chooses where the message appears.

Display the message below the clock

1. Check **Show message** below the Opacity slider.
2. Enter **End time** using a 24-hour time such as 10:00 or 9:30.
3. Enter **Message**, for example Service starts in.
4. Leave **Send to OBS text source instead of clock** unchecked.

ClockFace appends the remaining time to your message. It uses MM:SS, beginning at 60:00. For example: **Service starts in 05:00**.

The message appears one hour before the selected End time, disappears at End time, and repeats the next day. It follows the source's selected time zone. Unchecking Show message disables both the message and countdown.

Daily message example

With End time set to **10:00**, the schedule is:

Time in the selected zone	Result
Before 09:00	Message is hidden
09:00	Service starts in 60:00
09:55	Service starts in 05:00
10:00	Message is hidden
09:00 the next day	The daily countdown starts again

An invalid End time is marked in the properties window and produces no countdown. The analog clock continues to run. A blank Message displays just MM:SS.

The inline message row keeps its space while enabled, even outside the display interval. This prevents the clock source from resizing when the message appears or clears. Longer messages are reduced to fit; very long text may be shortened on screen. Use an external text source for more control over formatting.

Send the message to a text source

Use this option when you want OBS to control the message's font, size, color, placement, and filters independently of the clock.

1. Create a dedicated **Text (GDI+)** or **Text (FreeType 2)** source in OBS. The exact source label depends on the OBS installation. Keep **Read from file** off.
2. Add that text source to the scene where you want the message to appear. Set its font, size, colors, alignment, position, and filters in OBS.
3. Open the ClockFace source properties and check **Show message**.
4. Set End time and Message.
5. Check **Send to OBS text source instead of clock**. Select the dedicated source from the **Countdown text source** dropdown.
6. If you created the text source after opening the clock properties, close and reopen the properties to refresh the list.
7. Check the result during the final hour before End time. The selected source receives the complete message plus MM:SS.

Checking this option removes the message row from the clock. Only the text content of the selected source is updated. Its font, colors, transforms, filters, and visibility remain under your control in OBS.

The selected text source is cleared outside the one-hour interval, including at End time. Use a dedicated source so the countdown does not replace other text. Do not assign two clocks to the same text source.

Renaming a selected text source preserves its connection. If you delete and recreate it, select the replacement in the dropdown. A missing source is identified as unavailable.

The clock continues updating the selected text source even when the clock itself is not visible. Keep the clock source in the scene collection. Switching destinations, disabling the feature, or removing the clock clears its last published text when that text still belongs to the clock.

Quick test: Set End time a few minutes ahead in the selected zone, verify the displayed MM:SS, then check that the text clears at End time. Restore the intended schedule afterward.

Troubleshoot and maintain

Symptom	What to check
ClockFace is absent from Sources	Confirm the correct platform build and architecture, its installation path, and a complete OBS restart. Use the installer matching the way OBS was installed. Check Help > Log Files > View Current Log.
Duplicate or unexpected clock entries	Remove earlier copies of this clock DLL from other plugin locations. An old Lua Clock source is a separate source type.
Numbers or marks are missing	Check Show numbers and Show tick marks. Your background may already contain its own markings.
Color controls are missing	Check Override artwork colors. Countdown color is not used in external text-source mode.
A scheduled message is missing	Check Show message, valid End time, the selected time zone, and whether the current time is within the final hour.
An external text source stays blank	Confirm its dropdown selection, Read from file off, scene visibility, and the one-hour schedule. Reopen properties after creating a new text source.
Digital labels have poor contrast	Enable Override artwork colors and choose a suitable Digital time and date color.

Installation references

OBS plugin guide: https://obsproject.com/kb/plugins-guide

OBS 33 Windows layout: https://obsproject.com/kb/legacy-plugin-developer-info